



Delaware County Council Meeting November 24th 2020

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lezn_QmltW8
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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: November 24, 2020

Body: Delaware County Council

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer [00:00:12](#) called the meeting of the Delaware County Council to order at [00:00:12](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Ballard, Ms. Lassiter, Ms. Piper, Mr. Alexander, and Presiding Officer Mr. Hughes. (Note: Four council members were explicitly noted as present at [00:01:56](#), with a total quorum established for unanimous voting requirements).
 - **Members Absent:** (None explicitly noted as absent during roll call).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Hughes.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Mark [00:00:21](#). Public questions were directed to the county council email address (county council d-i-s-t at co.delaware.in.us).

- **Approval of Agenda:** The agenda was confirmed as posted and advertised. Approved by roll call vote (Unanimous) [00:02:44](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Prior meeting minutes were approved following a motion by Jessica and a second by Ryan. Approved by roll call vote (Unanimous) [00:03:24](#).
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **[00:03:42](#) Financial Transfers & Line Item Adjustments (Multiple Departments):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Steve (reading on behalf of Donna).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council reviewed and processed numerous routine end-of-year budget transfers and line-item adjustments to achieve net-zero changes across various departments, including:
 - *Circuit Court:* First item withdrawn; second item (Probation Officer adjustments) approved [00:05:26](#).
 - *Emergency Medical Service (EMS):* Advanced EMT line-item reallocations. Approved [00:05:56](#).
 - *Prosecutor:* Investigator vs. legal services. Approved [00:06:38](#).
 - *Public Defender's Office:* Fund line shifts (b to c, d to e). Approved [00:07:25](#).
 - *Alcasa Grant:* Instructional costs/meetings moved to office equipment. Approved [00:08:05](#).
 - *Fum Bridge:* Equipment operator to FICA. Approved [00:08:36](#).
 - *DOC Grant:* 18-month grant payback adjustments of unspent funds to DOC. Approved [00:12:08](#).
 - *Enhance 9-1-1:* Insurance to long-term disability. Approved [00:12:37](#).
 - *Prosecutor LEED:* Victim advocate and investigator line adjustments. Approved [00:13:37](#).
 - *Sales Disclosure Fund:* Schooling to copier. Approved [00:15:02](#).
 - *Delaware County Office of Information (GIS):* Contractual services and software maintenance moved to equipment for vehicle safety gear. Approved [00:16:17](#).
 - *Ineligible Standard Deduction:* Contractual services moved to equipment (laptops and replacement coffee machine). Approved [00:17:01](#).
 - *Addendum (Commissioners):* Health insurance moved to cover part-time staff through year-end. Approved [00:17:49](#).
 - *Communications:* Tech lines and part-time/OIC adjustments. Approved [00:18:43](#).
 - *Emergency Medical Service:* Advanced EMT to education incentive pay. Approved [00:19:36](#).
 - *Jail:* Correctional officer line adjustments. Approved [00:20:08](#).
 - *Sheriff:* Vehicle maintenance moved to equipment. Approved [00:20:51](#).

- *LOND*: Correction officer line adjustments. Approved 00:21:24.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** All listed routine transfers were individually approved by unanimous roll call votes.
- 00:21:33 **Financial Agenda: Prosecutor Seizure Fund Request**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rhonda (via phone) / Prosecutor's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$14,000 from the seizure fund (442 furniture requests) to purchase furniture for a new building. Council members raised concerns because an invoice indicated the items had already been purchased prior to council appropriation approval. Council emphasized that while the prosecutor controls the fund, prior courtesy notification and appropriation approval are expected.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Unanimous) 00:30:26 following discussion and apologies regarding procedural timing.
- 00:30:37 **Financial Agenda: EMA Small Aircraft Grant Fund**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Corey / EMA.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$4,883 (441 equipment) funded via a Ball Brothers Foundation rapid grant to purchase a drone equipped with thermal imaging (FLIR), a spotlight, speaker/microphone, and night-flight capabilities. The drone will assist the sheriff's department, search and rescue, hazmat teams, and local fire departments.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Unanimous) 00:37:09.
- 00:37:15 **Financial Agenda: Public Defender Supplemental Department**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Public Defender Office Representatives & Ted Baker (Board Member).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$50,000 from supplemental funds (office furniture and equipment) to purchase Microsoft Surface Pro laptops for every attorney and staff member. Officials highlighted the stark technology disparity between prosecutors (fully equipped digital files/projections) and public defenders (paper files and chalkboards). Purchases will be submitted for CARES Act reimbursement, with 40% backstopped by the State Public Defender Commission if denied.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Unanimous) 00:53:39.
- 00:49:51 **Additional Financial Agenda Items (Rapid-Fire Approvals):**
 - *Supreme Court Grant (8108)*: \$20,000 for client incentives, drug screens, and travel/training for problem-solving courts. Approved by Voice Vote / Unanimous roll call 00:54:33.

- *Sales Disclosure Fund (1131)*: \$1,344 for copier balance. Approved by roll call [00:55:06](#).
 - *COVID GIS Fund (9207)*: \$4,000 for gasoline and contractual services (continuation of COVID weekly communication grant/newsletter via Ball Brothers). Approved by roll call [00:55:54](#).
 - **00:56:10 Omnibus Financial & Hiring Freeze Action:**
 - **Motion:** Motion to approve financial transfers, amend the salary ordinance with line reductions, and amend hiring freeze ordinance 2020–015.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Unanimous) [00:56:34](#).
 - **01:00:07 Ordinance 2020-022: GIS Electronic Map Fund & Open Data Initiative**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kyle / GIS Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Introduction of an ordinance updating the management of the GIS electronic map fund (originally created in 1999). It replaces outdated data-purchase models with an “open data initiative” providing free public geospatial data access, updates printed map fees, and establishes a tiered fee structure for outside government agencies utilizing county data-hosting services.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced for action at the December meeting; roll call vote to introduce passed unanimously [01:05:59](#).
 - **01:06:16 2021 Meeting Schedule:**
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of the proposed 2021 meeting calendar.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Unanimous) [01:06:54](#).
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- No members of the public spoke during the general public comment period. (Council noted zero emails and zero Facebook comments received) [01:13:55](#).
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Paul Singleton (911 Director) provided an update that the new 911 phone system went live the previous week without major issues, and future reimbursable grants will be processed through the state [00:58:28](#).
 - Council discussed an upcoming appointment to the 911 Board, deferring final action to the December meeting pending contract review by legal counsel [00:56:40](#).
 - Council members voiced strong frustration regarding the Indiana State Legislature’s first priority upon returning to session being the exemption of legislators from mask mandates rather than addressing local municipal or taxpayer concerns [01:07:05](#).
 - **Kudos:** Commended the Clerk’s Office and Recorder’s Office for running a smooth election with new electronic poll books, and praised Clerk Rick and Regina McIntyre

for accommodating an emergency late-night marriage license issuance for a resident 01:10:14.

- **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn made by Ryan, seconded by Jessica. Approved unanimously by roll call vote 01:15:02.

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